OLATZ ROMÁN

University of Mannheim
Department of Economics
L7 3-5, 68161 Mannheim, Germany

Updated: October 15, 2026
Contact: **olatz.roman@uni-mannheim.de**
Webpage: **olatzroman.github.io**

Academic Positions and Memberships

Postdoctoral Scholar, University of Mannheim — *2025 - present*

Member of Collaborative Research Center Transregio 224 "Economic Perspectives on Societal Challenges" (Project A03) — *2025 - present*

Member of the Macro Inequality Lab — *2025 - present*

Education

PhD in Economics, European University Institute (Florence) — *2019 - 2025*
Supervisors: Thomas F. Crossley and Alexander Monge-Naranjo
Thesis title: Essays in the Economics of Couples

Visiting Scholar, University of California, Berkeley — *Spring 2022*
Host: Enrico Moretti

MSc in Economics and Finance, Barcelona Graduate School of Economics — *2017 - 2018*

Bachelor in Economics, University of the Basque Country (Bilbao) — *2013 - 2017*
Erasmus Exchange Program: Katholieke Universiteit Leuven (2016-2017)

Research Fields

Labor Economics, Gender Economics, Family Economics

Working Papers

Children, Household Specialization and Relationship Quality, *with Belén Rodríguez-Moro*

"We study how having children affects the quality of couples' relationships. Relationship quality captures the non-material gains from being in a relationship, which are central to models of family formation and dissolution. Using rich longitudinal data from the United Kingdom, we construct and validate a novel measure of relationship quality (RQ). Exploiting variation in the timing of first births in a dynamic difference-in-differences framework, we find a sharp and persistent RQ decline of approximately half a standard deviation, sustained for at least seven years. This effect is symmetric across mothers and fathers, in contrast to the large gender asymmetries documented in the parenthood literature. We establish gender-based household specialization as the key mechanism."

The Geography of Jobs and Couple Migration

"This paper studies how joint geographic constraints induced by partners' occupations shape couples' migration decisions. Using novel measures of geographic concentration and occupational overlap, I find that geographically restricted occupations both significantly limit couples' ability to relocate and, conditional on moving, are associated with worse post-migration outcomes. This negative association with migration and misallocation is mitigated when partners' occupations exhibit a high degree of geographic overlap. I exploit the introduction of occupational licensing policies as exogenous shocks to job geography, showing that licensing-induced increases in concentration substantially reduce cross-state mobility, particularly for married individuals, highlighting the role of joint location constraints in shaping couples migration decisions."

Returns to Size in Local Marriage Markets, *with Ana Moreno-Maldonado*

"This paper studies whether there are returns to size in local marriage markets. Using a stylized search model of couple formation, we show that rates of couple formation and dissolution are insufficient to identify returns to market size when meeting technologies differ across locations. This is because higher meeting rates increase not only the frequency of encounters but also the option value of remaining single, raising the minimum match quality individuals are willing to accept to enter a relationship. We show how a measure of match quality can be used to identify returns to size in some circumstances. Guided by the model, we empirically study marriage markets using a novel measure of relationship quality. Adapting methods from the labour economics literature to account for endogenous sorting into cities, we find evidence of constant returns to size. Not only formation and dissolution rates do not change with city size, but also match quality displays a flat profile."

Teaching Experience

PhD level – European University Institute

2023	Topics in Labor Economics (Co-instructor)
2022	Economic Measurement (TA)
2020, 2021	Statistics and Econometrics II - Econometric Models for Micro Data (TA)

Graduate level – Florence School of Banking and Finance

2020, 2021	Panel Data for Banking Sector Analysis (TA)

Undergraduate level

2026	Macroeconomics A (Lead TA) – University of Mannheim
2023	Econometrics (TA) – New York University Florence
2018	Economics and Analytical Instruments for the Study of Law (TA) – Universitat Pompeu Fabra
2017	Business Organization and Administration II (TA) – Universitat Pompeu Fabra
2017	Macroeconomics II (TA) – Universitat Pompeu Fabra

Research Experience and Other Employment

2018-2019	Research Assistant to Monica Martinez-Bravo, CEMFI (Madrid)
2014-2015	Research Assistant to Juan Ramón Murua, University of the Basque Country (Bilbao)

Professional Activities

Presentations: *(* scheduled)*

2026	EAYE Annual Meeting (Bilbao), SEHO Annual Meeting (Pavia), EALE Conference (Barcelona), University of Magdeburg*, CEPR WE_ARE Seminar Series* (online)
2025	ifo Institute (Munich), Masaryk University (Brno), 2nd Mini-Conference on Gender Economics (Florence), Mend the Gap in Economic Opportunities workshop (Rome), XXVIII Workshop on Dynamic Macroeconomics (Vigo), EEA Congress 2025 (Bordeaux), 19th North American Meeting of the Urban Economics Association (Montreal), 16th CRC-TR 224 retreat (Offenbach), Institutions and Frictions in the Labor Market workshop (Nuremberg), CRC-TR 224 Family & Gender Economics Workshop (Mannheim)
2024	IZA (Bonn), SOLE Annual Meeting (Portland), University of the Basque Country (Bilbao), Economics of Migration Junior Seminar (online), UniTo - Collegio Carlo Alberto Ph.D. Workshop in Economics (Torino), SAEe (Palma de Mallorca), EWMES (Palma de Mallorca)
2023	18th Doctorissimes Conference (Paris), Understanding Society Conference (Essex), EALE Conference (Prague), Inequalities in Education, Labor Markets and Families Conference (Florence)
2022	IRLE Visiting Scholar Workshop (Berkeley)

Academic Service:

2026-*present*	CRC-TR 224 Young Researchers Representative
March 2024, 2025	Organizer, Mini-conference in Gender Economics, EUI
2023-2024, 2024-2025	Co-organizer, Gender Talks at Villa La Fonte, EUI
2020-2021	Co-organizer, Microeconometrics Working Group, EUI

Refereeing: Journal of Political Economy, The B.E. Journal of Economic Analysis and Policy, European Societies.

DISCUSSIONS

North American Meeting of the Urban Economic Association October 2025
"Understanding the Congestion Child Penalty: a Look at Labor Force Participation, Time Use and Work from Home"
by Ilaria D'Angelis and Keren Horn

PSE-CEPR Policy Forum June 2025
"Rise in Home Working and Spousal Labor Supply"
by Mylene Feuillade, Dominique Goux and Eric Maurin

Economics of Migration Junior Seminar November 2024
"The Effect of Initial Location Assignment on Healthcare Utilization of Refugees"
by Shobhit Kulshreshtha

HONORS, SCHOLARSHIPS AND AWARDS

2026	Marie Skodowska-Curie Postdoctoral Fellowship (Planned for 2027), "The Geography of Jobs: Gender Gaps in Mobility and Opportunity (GeMO)" – 202,000 €, sole PI
2026	Teaching Prize of the Economics Student Council for Post-Docs and W1 Professors
2022	US Department Visiting Grant, European University Institute
2019-2023	Beca Salvador de Madariaga, Spanish Ministry of Science, Innovation & University
2019	Beca del Banco de España *(declined due to scholarship incompatibility)*
2017-2018	Teaching Assistant Scholarship, Universitat Pompeu Fabra
2017	Half tuition waiver, Universitat Pompeu Fabra
2017	Academic Excellence Award, University of the Basque Country
2016	Erasmus Scholarship, European Commission
2013	Academic Excellence Award, Basque Government

OTHER SKILLS

Languages:
English (fluent), Spanish (native), Basque (native), Italian (advanced), German (basic)

Programming Skills:
Stata, Matlab, Python, R, Latex